

Open source software crucial for print media now: Kerala CM



The chief minister of Kerala, Pinarayi Vijayan, has said that free and open source software that offer solutions to IT startups and the publishing industry can counter the exploitative business practices of software monopolies, the *New Indian Express* reported. He also said that open source software was the need of the hour for the print media.

The CM added that the print media is facing challenges from proprietary software companies such as Adobe. He mentioned that the Kerala government is focused on developing free and open source software from the school level. He was speaking at a function in Thiruvananthapuram.

The IT@School operating system (OS) of the Kerala government will include several free applications customised for the state school curriculum, including an open source office suite, language input tools, database applications, DTP (desktop publishing) graphics, image editing software, sound recordings, etc. The OS will be installed in more than 14,000 government and government-aided schools from Classes 1 to 12.

Red Hat open sources Project Quay

Red Hat has made Project Quay, the upstream project that represents the code that powers Red Hat Quay and Quay.io, open source. Quay is a private hosted registry that was launched in 2013.

Project Quay contains a collection of open source software, licensed under Apache 2.0 and other open source licences. It follows an open source governance model, with a maintainer committee. The Quay team also created and integrated the Clair open source container security scanning project in 2015, and it includes Red Hat and community maintainers and users.

Quay was acquired in 2014 by CoreOS, which aimed to secure the Internet through automated operations. Clair helps users to identify known vulnerabilities in their container registries. It was created in the open source community to improve security through open work amongst vendors and users.

WhiteSource acquires dependency update solution, Renovate

WhiteSource, the open source security and licence compliance management



company, has acquired the open source dependency update solution, Renovate. The company said that Renovate's current commercial offerings will be available for free under its new name, WhiteSource Renovate, and will include a GitHub app, a GitLab app and a self-hosted solution.

Google introduces open source project for VR viewer

According to a recent report by ZDNet, Google has launched an open source project for its Google Cardboard to allow developers to build additional experiences and add support to their apps for various smartphone screen solutions and configurations.

Google has introduced libraries for developers to build their Cardboard apps for Apple iOS and Android. The libraries support virtual reality (VR) features such as motion tracking, lens distortion rendering, and user interaction via the viewer button.



There is also an Android QR code library. Apps can be paired with any Cardboard viewer without the need for the Cardboard app.

"An open source model will enable the community to continue to improve Cardboard support and expand its capabilities, for example, by adding support for new smartphone display configurations and Cardboard viewers as they become available," said Google AR and VR product manager, Jeffrey Chen.

Chen added, "We'll continue to contribute to the Cardboard open source project by releasing new features, including an SDK package for Unity." He added that while the overall usage of Cardboard has declined and Google is no longer actively developing the Google VR software development kit, making Cardboard open source will allow it to be used consistently for entertainment and education experiences, such as YouTube and Expeditions.